How to Solve a Nonogram

A nonogram is a grid of squares that hides a picture. Your job is to work out which squares to shade.

The numbers beside each row tell you the runs of shaded squares in that row, in order from left to right. The numbers above each column do the same, from top to bottom. So "3 1" means a run of 3 shaded squares, then at least one blank, then a single shaded square.

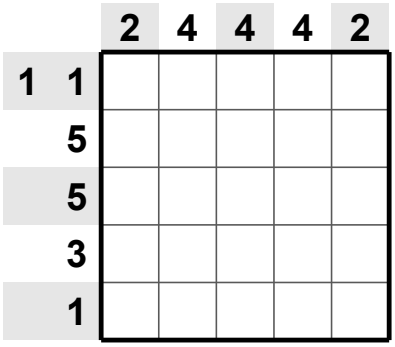
Where to start

Look for big numbers. In a 15-square row, a clue of 12 must cover the middle 9 squares however you place it, so you can shade those straight away.

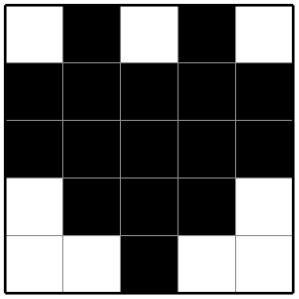
Work back and forth between rows and columns. Each new square you fill gives you more to go on.

Every grid in this book can be solved without guessing.

A tiny example:



The clues



The solved picture: a heart

Step 1. Rows 2 and 3 say 5 in a 5-square row, so shade every square.

Step 2. Columns 1 and 5 say 2, and rows 2 and 3 already give them that run, so their other squares are blank.

Step 3. Row 4 says 3 and its end squares are blank, so shade the middle three. Columns 2, 3 and 4 now each need one more square, at the top or the bottom.

Step 4. Row 1 says 1 1, two squares with a gap: that is columns 2 and 4. So column 3 takes the bottom square. The heart is done.

How the Cases Work

Each case is told on a left-hand page: the crime, four suspects, and a witness note.

1. Read the case

Something was left at the scene. You do not know what yet.

2. Solve the grid

The nonogram on the facing page reveals the object. Shade it in, then write its name under the grid.

3. Find the two suspects

Look at the suspects again. Exactly two of them are linked to that object.

4. Read the witness note

The witness note clears one of those two. Whoever is left is the culprit. Tick the boxes beside the suspects as you rule them out.

Two parts

Part One holds twenty village cases on 15 x 15 grids. Part Two holds twenty harder cases on 20 x 20 grids. Solutions, with the reasoning for every case, are at the back.

The Last Light at Thornbury

The storm cut the power at Thornbury Hall at ten o'clock. When the lights came back at eleven, Lord Thornbury lay still in his study and the safe stood open. Whoever crossed the pitch-dark hall had needed a light, and they left it behind on the study carpet.

THE SUSPECTS

- ☐ **Mrs. Agnes Vane** *the housekeeper*
  Carries a brass candlestick on her rounds every night.
- ☐ **Mr. Cyril Crisp** *the secretary*
  Lit a candle in the library to finish his letters.
- ☐ **Miss Lydia Hale** *the niece*
  Wears a gold hairpin shaped like a crown.
- ☐ **Dr. Edwin Moss** *the family doctor*
  Times every pulse with a pocket hourglass.

WITNESS NOTE

The library door was locked from the outside all hour, and the butler held the only key. He let Mr. Crisp out at eleven.

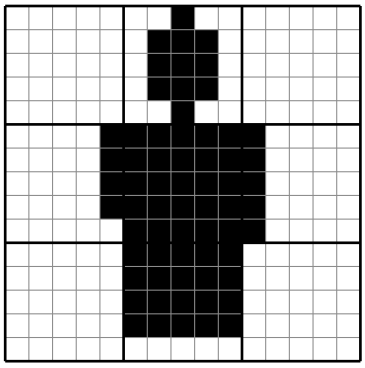
Solve the grid opposite to see what was left at the scene. Two suspects are linked to it. Use the witness note to clear one of them.

The culprit is: _____

	0	0	0	0	4	9	39	14	39	9	5	0	0	0	0
1															
3															
3															
3															
1															
7															
7															
7															
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The object is: _____ Solved on: _____

Solutions

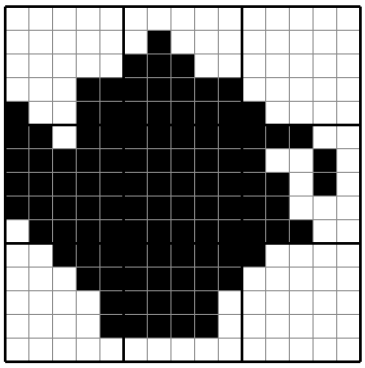


CASE 01 · The Last Light at Thornbury

The object: Candle

The culprit: Mrs. Agnes Vane

Linked to the candle: Mrs. Agnes Vane and Mr. Cyril Crisp. Mr. Crisp was locked in the library all hour, so the candle was Mrs. Vane's.

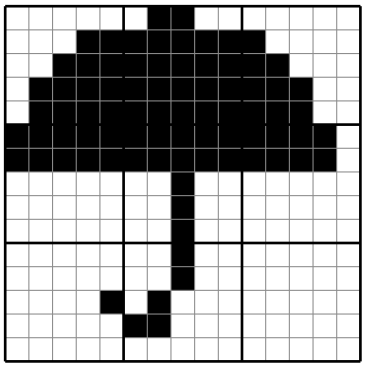


CASE 02 · Poison at the Parish Fete

The object: Teapot

The culprit: Mrs. Mabel Pell

Linked to the teapot: Mrs. Mabel Pell and Mrs. Dora Finch. Mrs. Finch's teapot was smashed at noon, so the hidden pot was Mrs. Pell's.

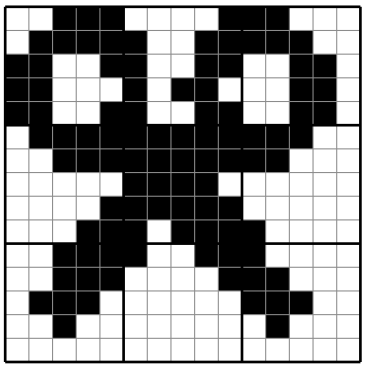


CASE 03 · Death on Wellmead Bridge

The object: Umbrella

The culprit: Mr. Hugh Danby

Linked to the umbrella: Mr. Hugh Danby and Miss Penny Avery. Miss Avery's umbrella was locked in the porter's lodge from six, so the one in the reeds was Mr. Danby's.



CASE 04 · The Tailor's Final Fitting

The object: Scissors

The culprit: Miss Iris Fenn

Linked to the scissors: Miss Iris Fenn and Mrs. Clara Cole. Mrs. Cole's scissors were locked in her office from five while she sat at the front desk, so the blades were Miss Fenn's.